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The NOVASOIL project aims to show the benefits for society and the environment of investing in soil health.

The main output of the project will be a tool to analyse the suitability of different business cases that promote soil health.

This tool will be based on best practice examples in Europe and other countries, as well as on the needs and demands of society.

Rabo Carbon bank

Summarize



The Dutch **Rabobank** supports farmers in developing sustainable business models (e.g., by offering financing solutions and agronomic advice). These business models seek carbon reductions by switching towards regenerative farming practices. Practices include reductions in chemical fertilisers and pesticides, improvements in crop rotation, adding cover crops, and rising water levels. The carbon reduction achieved by these practices is verified, and carbon credits are sold.

The bank operates internationally. Three-year trials for the described 'Rabo Carbon Bank' currently run in the US and the Netherlands with dairy and arable farmers (Banken NL, 2022). The generated carbon credits are sold to large companies such as Vattenfall (Rabobank, 2022)

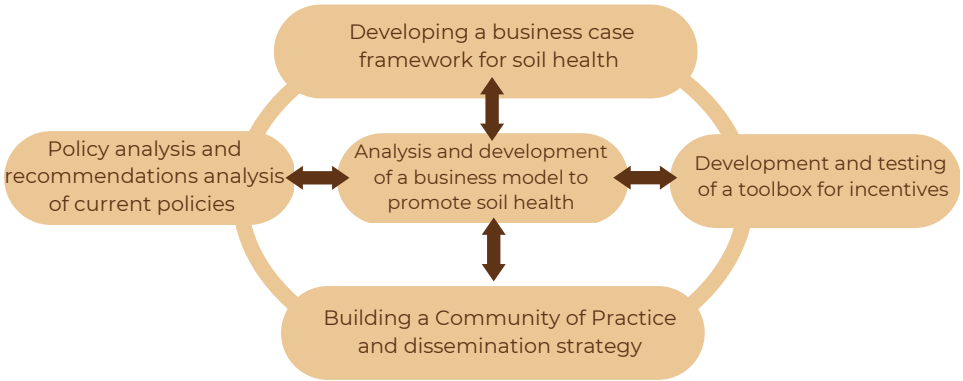


Figure 1. Structure of the NOVASOIL project

Objectives

In the **NOVASOIL Project**, we will analyse factors relevant to Dutch farmers' acceptance of the business model. A discrete choice experiment (DCE) will be used to determine the influence of contract attributes (e.g., contract lengths, financial and agronomic support, prices on offer, and management requirements) and current farming practices. To identify relevant attributes for the experiment, cooperation with the relevant stakeholders (Dutch farmers, Rabobank) will be sought.

Case studies properties

Potential inhibitors

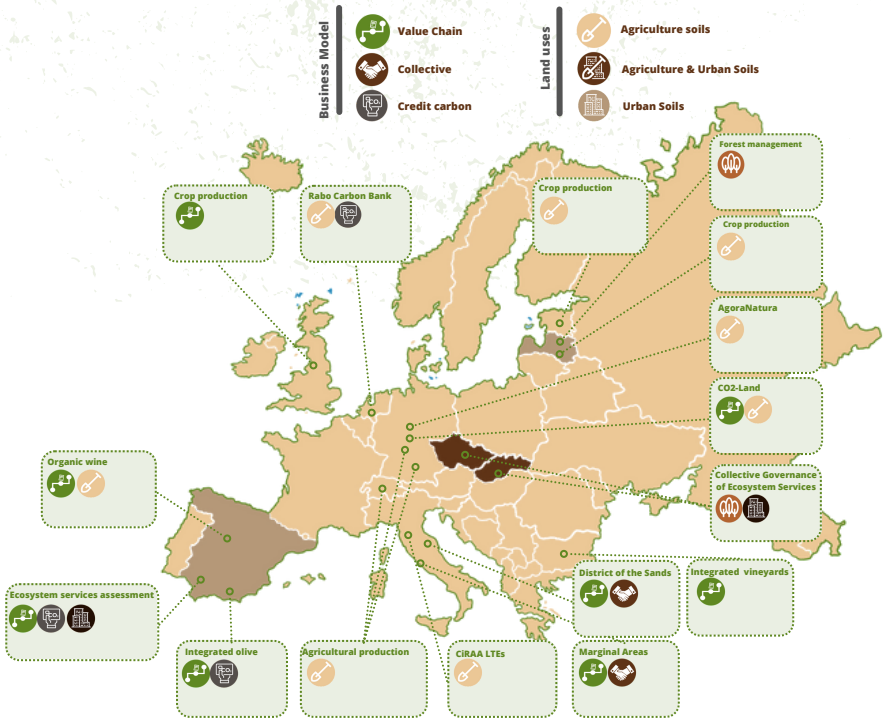
High agricultural commodity prices may encourage intensive farming practices

Potential enablers

Social awareness (interested in regenerative farming practices), policies, potential support for investments (e.g., in technologies)

Potential stakeholders

Rabobank and other financial service providers, farmers, farmers' associations, farmer collectives



Ecosystem services

CO_2 Carbon storage

Water quality

Soil quality

Specific objectives

SO1 Multi-dimensional portfolio development of business cases and good examples for investing in soil health in Europe and beyond.

SO2 Analysis of current models around the world for creating new incentives and new revenues from healthy soils.

SO3 Apply a co-development approach to modelling that promotes soil health.

SO4 Develop a prototype incentive toolbox and test network.

SO5 Analysis of current policies and technologies related to soil health and income provision for farmers.

SO6 Developing a community of practice around investors and key soil health actors.

SO7 Increase interest in soil health through a digital marketing strategy plan

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INNOVATIVE BUSINESS MODELS FOR SOIL HEALTH

https://novasoil-project.eu

